



kshamtalaya

2022- 23 ANNUAL REPORT

BUILDING SCHOOLS
AS HUBS OF
COMPASSION AND
COMMUNITY





All Children Will Realise Their True Potential
through Meaningful, Relevant and
Compassionate Education.



www.kshamtalaya.org

Who Are We

Kshamtalaya was envisaged in 2016 after witnessing the widespread inequalities in the most underserved communities of tribal-rural Rajasthan. We intervene to improve school enrolment, attendance, academic outcomes and life prospects for the students in rural and marginalised settings. We want to actualize a rural India in which children successfully make a transition from compulsory school education to life afterwards and go on to live happy and productive lives.



Year of Inception

2016

Socials



www.kshamtalaya.org



@kshamtalaya

kshamtalayafoundation

Organization

Section 8, for purpose
Not-for-profit company

Geographies

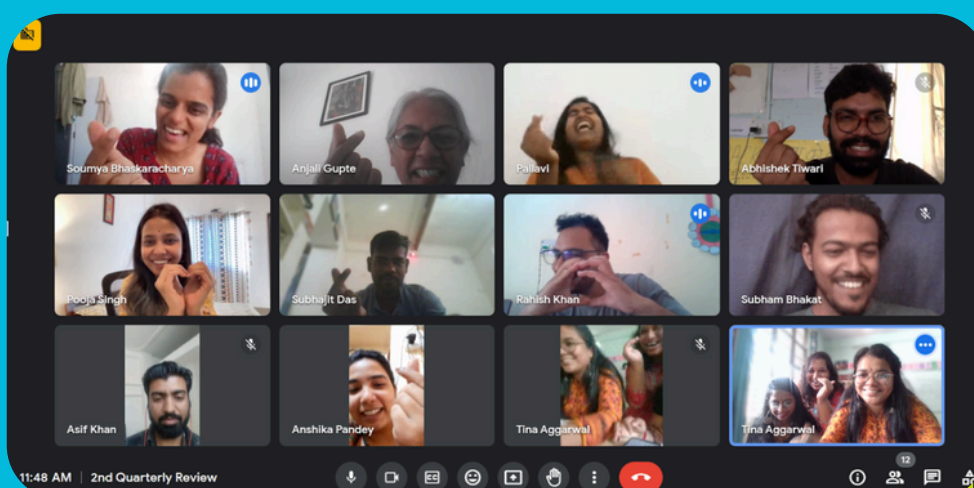
Kotra, Gogunda (Udaipur District) &
Pindwara (Sirohi District) Rajasthan
Samastipur District, Bihar
Seemapuri, Delhi

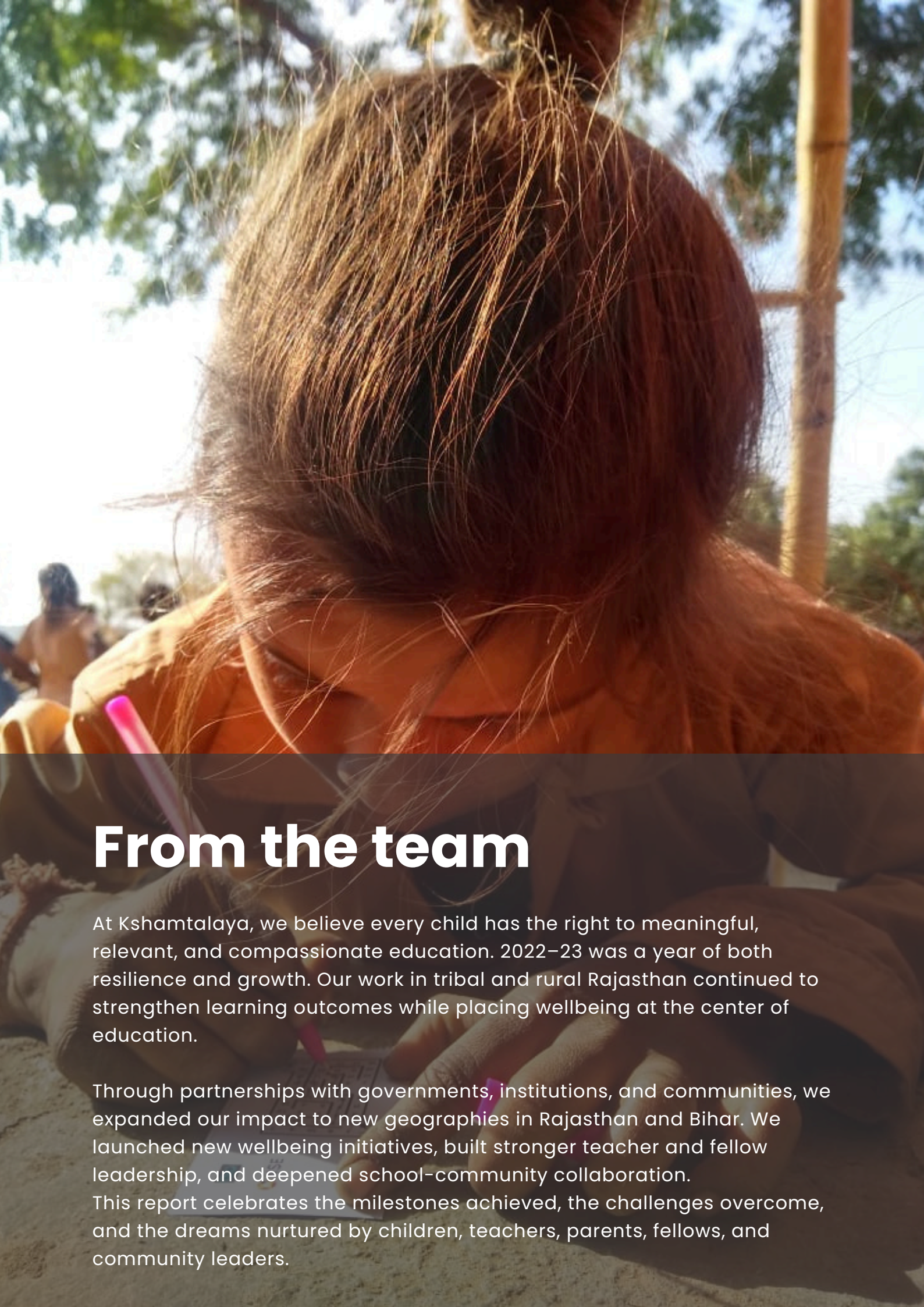
Team Size:

16 Anchor Team Members

30 iDISCOVER fellows

200+ Volunteers/Interns





From the team

At Kshamtalaya, we believe every child has the right to meaningful, relevant, and compassionate education. 2022–23 was a year of both resilience and growth. Our work in tribal and rural Rajasthan continued to strengthen learning outcomes while placing wellbeing at the center of education.

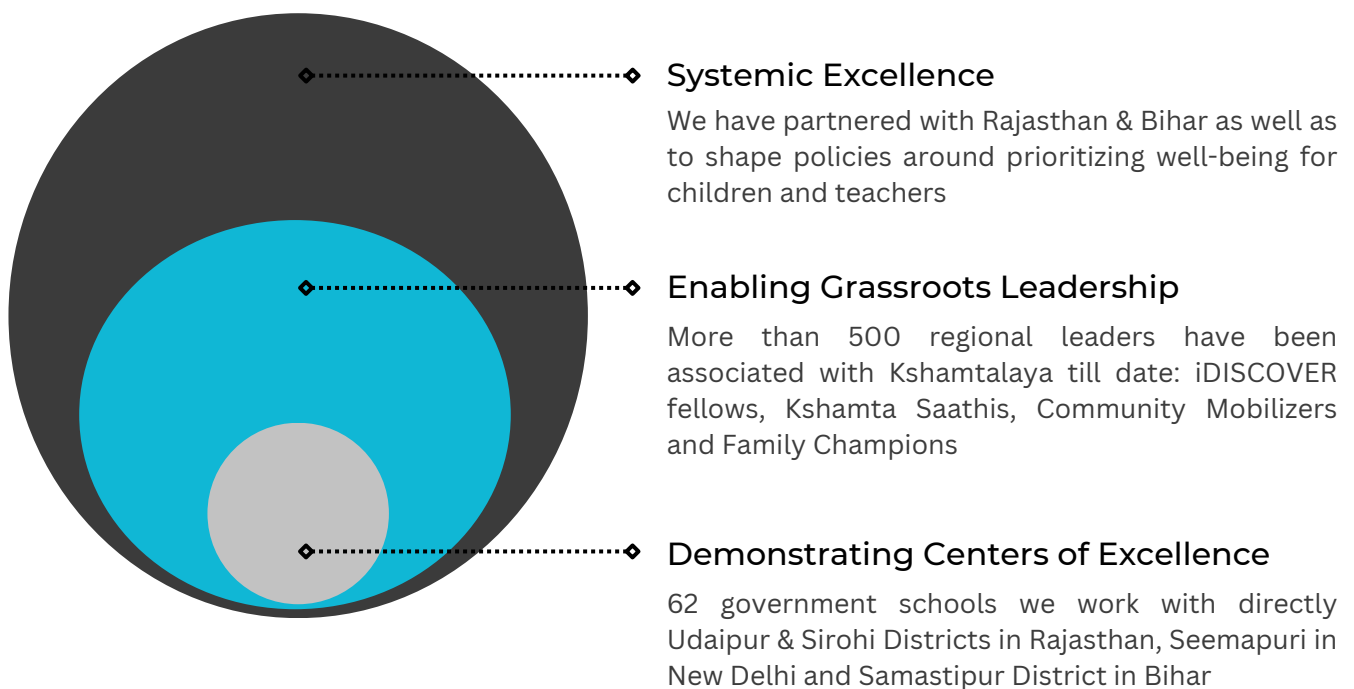
Through partnerships with governments, institutions, and communities, we expanded our impact to new geographies in Rajasthan and Bihar. We launched new wellbeing initiatives, built stronger teacher and fellow leadership, and deepened school-community collaboration. This report celebrates the milestones achieved, the challenges overcome, and the dreams nurtured by children, teachers, parents, fellows, and community leaders.

Our Approach

Our mission is to empower children with foundational learning, well-being, and life skills through a community-driven educational movement where parents, educators, school leaders, and regional stakeholders actively collaborate to cultivate purposeful, high-quality learning environments. By establishing centers of excellence within each school, we set a standard for educational impact, drawing insights from our work to shape policies at the state level.

We are demonstrating high quality, child-centric classroom instructional learning and community-led educational movements can be successful in the areas that are considered the most underserved.

How we work: We have taken a stand to work in the backstage. We believe the “**COMMUNITY KNOWS BEST**” and also recognize the value of engagement and empowerment of the Community so that they can take the forefront and lead from front. And, to maximise impact - we actively learn from our 80 demonstration centers within Government schools and inform policies at the state levels.



DEMONSTRATING EXCELLENCE

PROJECTS & REACH

Demonstrating excellence is our first approach that provides us the opportunity learn first-hand where we directly with Children of primary grades and teachers. This is the most important approach as it builds our knowledge through practice.

IDISCOVER FELLOWSHIP

RAJASTHAN: 50 SCHOOLS | 25 FELLOWS
BIHAR: 10 SCHOOLS | 5 FELLOWS

WHOLE SCHOOL TRANSFORMATION

DELHI: 2 SCHOOLS | 1 TEACHER
SUPPORT LEAD & 1 COMMUNITY LEAD

OUTREACH NUMBERS (DIRECT ENGAGEMENT)

2500 CHILDREN	64 SCHOOLS	126 TEACHERS
2000+ PARENTS		

OUTPUT & OUTCOMES

77% OF STUDENTS REGULARLY ATTENDING SCHOOL	30,000+ TEACHING HOURS BY FELLOWS	3000+ TEACHER SUPPORT SESSIONS
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Welcome to Bihar!

Our work in Kotda, Gogunda & Pindwara blocks of Udaipur & Sirohi Districts focused on improving literacy, numeracy, and life skills for over 1,200 children, and the selection of Kotra's schools in T4 Education's Top 100 Best Schools have led to us partnering with the Bihar Government to continue our vision to one day initiate 100 Schools of Excellence.

We began our journey with 10 schools, beginning with the Learning Festivals and our iDISCOVER fellowship, a cohort of 5 fellows in Dalsingsarai, Vidyapati and Sarairanjan Blocks of Samastipur District,

Classroom Excellence

25 iDISCOVER fellows in 50 Schools iDISCOVER fellows set foot in Pindwara Block and a new state Bihar (Samastipur district), touching a milestone of 50 schools where the fellowship is actively running in the country with a cohort of 25 fellows!

A New State! New Opportunities to Learn & Grow : Bihar



- **Teacher Workshop** : Vision Building & Orientation
- **Learning Festivals** : 10 festivals covering 3 Blocks of Samastipur district
- **iDISCOVER fellowship** : Recruitment of 5 fellows for 10 schools & completing 10 days residential Induction Program

Fellow Growth Processes (Rajasthan & Bihar): Launching the Fellowship Curriculum in the iDISCOVER fellowship to model a holistic growth support structure to enable our fellows to further create Excellent Classrooms in Kotra, Gogunda, Pindwara of Rajasthan & Samastipur District of Bihar.

Capabilities



- Wellbeing Capabilities**
- Self awareness
 - Self regulation
 - Self expression
 - Self in ecosystem
 - Communication
 - System thinking
 - Impact career path/Vision Articulation



- Technical Skills**
- Design & Facilitation
 - Critical & Lateral Thinking
 - Data Driven Decision Making
 - Change Management
 - Project Management
 - Technology
 - Documentation
 - Entrepreneurial Mindset and Leadership



- Knowledge**
- Domain understanding (SEE, Sports and IL)
 - Community leadership
 - Territory knowledge

Opportunities



QUARTERLY THEMES

- Q 1- Understanding the ecosystem
- Q 2- Deepening the systemic understanding
- Q 3- Defining change- Self and System
- Q 4- Understanding Social Change Management
- Q 5- Design thinking
- Q 6- Create and Innovate
- Q 7- Create and Innovate
- Q 8- Sustain and Enable



PROCESSES

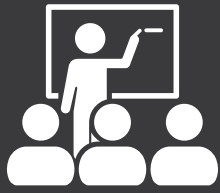
- Field Support
- Orientation & Bootcamps
- Capacity building
- Learning curriculum
- Kshamta Utsav
- Large Group Meetings
- Weekly Debriefs
- One to one



Integrated Learning & SEE Learning Teacher Workshop in Delhi: 12 Champion Teachers are adopting Integrated Learning Practices in 2 schools of EDMC Delhi. 605 students from two MCD schools in Delhi are experiencing the joy & value of integrating different subjects including Social Emotional and Ethical learning to foster learning in the students to model real life that students view around them with the help of 12 Champion Teachers through our Teacher Leadership program.

Learning Festivals

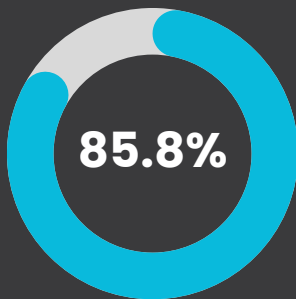




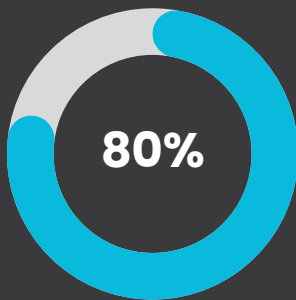
830
sessions

were conducted on themes such as Food, Trees and Plants.

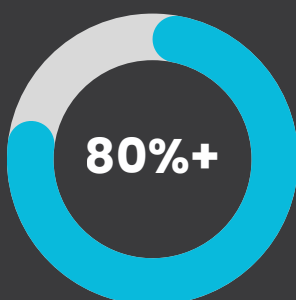
ENDLINE ASSESSMENTS SHOWED



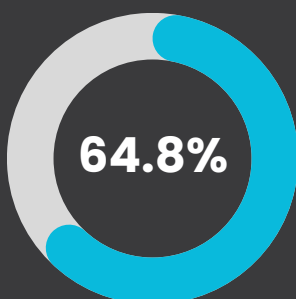
**children improved
in oral language
and reading**



**children improved
in writing skills**



**children improved in
mathematics
(number sense,
operations, patterns)**



**demonstrated
stronger life skills:
self-awareness,
resilience, attention**



Earlier, I thought repetition was the only way children learn. But when I co-facilitated an experiential activity with Amrit, I saw how curious and expressive the children became. They asked questions instead of only answering. Now I see that context and real-life connections make learning meaningful.

– Roshan Lal,
Primary Teacher,
Bhaga Fala School

ENABLING GRASSROOTS LEADERSHIP

FAMILY CHAMPIONS

SEEMAPURI AREA FROM DELHI RUNNING 24
LEARNING CENTERS IN 39 COMMUNITIES

HAUSLA WELLBEINGPRENEURS

RAJASTHAN: 20 FELLOWS | 2000 TEACHERS

PLAYQUITY-KSHAMTALAYA

KOTRA BLOCK, UDAIPUR

FALE FALE SHIKSHA MUHEEM

KOTRA BLOCK, UDAIPUR

The second pronged approach focuses on one of our key missions through which we are inching closer to our vision. Kshamtalaya right from 2017 and stronger since the pandemic has come to an important conclusion that enabling grassroot leadership is the most effective way to bring change. The Community Knows the right way to address issues affecting their own people.

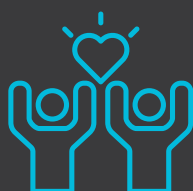
REACH



25
FAMILY
CHAMPIONS
GRADUATED



30
IDISCOVER
FELLOWS



24
WELL-BEING
PRENEURS

iDISCOVER Fellows : A Growing Cadre of Promising Regional Leaders Who Are Ready to Make A Difference!

"Most children including me are married early in our villages" recalled Ashok our batch 2 iDISCOVER fellow who is now a Government Teacher in Government Primary School Anjani. He was married before he was in grade 10 and would share how he was embarrassed going to school in uniform and being married. He also shared, how opportunities like the fellowship are so crucial for young people like him. "It opens up new opportunities for us that we often don't imagine for ourselves."

Working with rural youth is essential for cultivating sustainable change at the grassroots level. At Kshamtalaya, we're witnessing a gradual yet powerful transformation among the youth in Kotra, Gogunda, Pindwara, and Samastipur Districts, **where over 60 alumni are making an impact.** This emerging generation is reshaping their communities by stepping into roles that inspire and influence.

In Rajasthan, **three of our former fellows are now government teachers,** carrying forward the mission of quality education within the formal system. Others, like **Joshila, Pradeep, and Deepak,** have joined Kshamtalaya's leadership team, where they will lead community-based projects and mentor new youth leaders. **More than 12 alumni fellows are working in established development organizations. 2 alumni fellows are standing for local governance elections.** These young leaders are well-positioned to inspire others in their communities, as they understand the challenges and aspirations of rural areas from personal experience.



Our Growing Projects of “Community Leadership”



**With a Mission of Well-being + Entrepreneurship =
Well-beingpreneurs!**

A cohort of 24 development-professionals from all over the country have been brought together to create online Well-being Spaces for more than 2000 Teachers of Sirohi District by implementing the Hausla 21 Day Well-being Program (Selected as a Top Idea in year 2021 for the global solutions as part of the OpenIDEO challenge)



**25 Mothers Are Concerned & Taking a step for the Children of their
Communities in Dilshad Colony, Delhi**

25 women from the community and two community fellows, gained a strong sense of identity through the Family Champion program by leading 25 Learning Circles in their communities building FLN(Hindi and Math) at the learning centers, and running community libraries in an effort to close the gap of learning loss in the past two years.



Engaging Parents & SMCs

Schools thrive when communities are co-owners



79

Parent-Teacher Meetings conducted,
aligning families with children's progress.



19

SMC meetings held,
with 143 members oriented.



Sarpanches

**mobilized for festivals, annual
functions, and school improvements.**

CHALLENGES AND LEARNINGS



Teacher workload due to departmental
administrative tasks reduced participation
in workshops.



SMC literacy gaps limited their
contribution.



Learnings: decentralize training calendars,
prioritize relationship-building, and
gradually enhance SMC confidence.

Hausla Well-beingpreneurs: Giving Care to the Caregivers (Teachers) of Education System

"HAUSLA ARRIVED JUST WHEN I NEEDED IT, BOOSTING MY CONFIDENCE AND MENTAL HEALTH," SHARED ONE TEACHER. ANOTHER NOTED, "THIS PROGRAM BUILDS INNER STRENGTH AND RESILIENCE, AND I BELIEVE EVERYONE SHOULD EXPERIENCE IT."



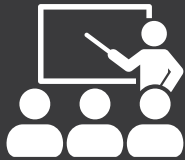
Teachers play an essential role in the lives of children, and their ability to nurture and lead is grounded in their own emotional stability. Hausla, our 21-day mental well-being series, was developed to equip educators with skills in self-awareness, compassion, emotional regulation, meaningful action, and social connection. The program consists of audio recordings featuring stories, reflections, and exercises, along with a workbook for ongoing practice. Teachers can participate in person or online, fostering a supportive cohort experience.

Our first cohort of Well-beingpreneurs in Rajasthan saw significant improvements. **69% of participants reported increased well-being on the WHO-5 Wellbeing Index, 59% showed enhanced mindfulness abilities on the Kentucky Inventory of Mindfulness Skills, and 38% demonstrated greater resilience on the Connor-Davidson Resilience Scale.** Hausla empowers teachers to create compassionate classrooms, even amid daily stressors, reflecting our commitment to holistic teacher support and the broader well-being of school communities.



24

wellbeing-preneurs
inducted.



480

teachers engaged in Pindwara
through a 21-day program.



GOAL:

2000+

Teachers to be reached by Oct 2023
with resilience-building tools.

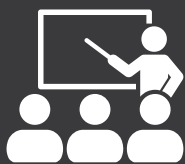


DIGITAL LEARNING EXPANDED VIA

Moodle

for tracking and scale

A TEAM THAT PRIORITISES CONTINUOUS LEARNING & GROWTH



Anchor team trained in Social, Emotional, and Ethical (SEE) Learning with Emory University.



Leaders attended Compassion Training and value-based leadership modules.



Research collaboration with Emory University to contextualize SEE Learning in 6 tribal schools.



Fale Fale Shiksha Muheem: Improving the foundational literacy & numeracy through a Peer-tutoring Model in remote villages of Kotra & Gogunda Blocks. This year, more than 160 Student Peer tutors are reaching 2000 children through after school learning circles.

What an Ultimate Time!: Community Ultimate Tournaments and a Career Boot Camp reaching more than 170 Student Volunteers in Kotra & Gogunda (Kshamta Saathi) of Fale Fale Shiksha Muheem program that aims to build a cadre of student volunteers who run learning circles.

An Ultimate Partnership! : We are also thrilled to collaborate with PlayQuity to make the game of Ultimate accessible to more youth of Kotda. Joshila Kumari is the first coach from Kotda block (she is an alumni of iDISCOVER fellowship) who has now started her batch in Jhed village, Kotra Block of Udaipur District.



SYSTEMS EXCELLENCE

The Systems Excellence vertical focusses on policy advocacy for Learning, Wellbeing & Governance that began last year with the Hausla intervention across 33 DIETs. The main duties is to support and cultivate leaders at the state-level key decision making levels to ensure that our learnings from Demonstrations & Community Leadership models can be scaled to district & state level.

STATE COUNCIL OF EDUCATIONAL RESEARCH & TRAINING, RAJASTHAN

- KHUSHISHALA: KHUD KI KHOJ - A Pivotal initiative by Kshamtalaya, Brio & RSCERT's Division 5 to make Wellbeing accessible to all primary grade children of Rajasthan
- STATE CURRICULUM FRAMEWORK
- ASSESSMENT CELL

DELHI BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION

DELHI: 2 SCHOOLS | 1 TEACHER
SUPPORT LEAD & 1 COMMUNITY LEAD



Khushi Shaala: Building Resilient Schools

In collaboration with RSCERT, Udaipur, we launched Khushi Shaala—a systemic initiative to integrate wellbeing into Rajasthan’s school education.

Wellbeing is not a luxury, rather a fundamental right.



"Every School in Rajasthan Will Thrive in Happiness!"

The year has proven to be a significant milestone marking our collaboration with RSCERT, Udaipur to launch the Khud ki Khoj curriculum. Under the Khushi Shaala umbrella project, we will together develop a Khud ki Khoj teacher handbook that will support the educators in integrating well-being practices in the classroom!

"Education Policy lays particular emphasis on the development of the creative potential of each individual. It is based on the principle that education must develop not only cognitive capacities - both the 'foundational capacities' of literacy and numeracy and 'higher-order' cognitive capacities, such as critical thinking and problem solving – but also social, ethical, and emotional capacities and dispositions."
(NEP 2020, Pg 4)

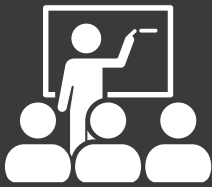
“Voices from our Partners



"This is a crucial element for a school where children are feeling connected, a sense of belongingness and happiness in their class, with their teachers and peers. Similarly for teachers to feel more and more connected with the Students. An ideal happy classroom will be where children and teachers enjoy what they are doing and their time together" - Kamendra Singh Ranawat, Deputy Director RSCERT

"We are paving the path of history by developing a curriculum on cultivating the wellbeing faculties in students and teachers. All the DC members have the major responsibilities on their shoulders to ensure the quality of the process and outcome"- Dr. Abha Sharma, Head of Division 5 Holistic Development and Social Justice, RSCERT





25

Development Committee members

(teachers, DIET faculty, Kshamtalaya team) oriented.



15

State Resource Group trainers

identified.



100

Teachers from

50

schools

will become wellbeing leaders.

WORKSHOP OUTCOMES



Created 25 review indicators (curriculum layout, inclusive language, constitutional values)



Translated the first Khud ki Khoj chapter into Hindi, contextualized for teachers and children.



Developed democratic rituals (gratitude circles, safe space agreements) to model wellbeing.



Entrepreneurship Mindset Curriculum, Delhi

In line with our vision that every child experiences meaningful, relevant and compassionate education, Kshamtalaya Foundation partnered with the Entrepreneurship Mindset Digital Design (EMDD) curriculum team of the Delhi Board of Secondary Education (DBSE). As curriculum co-developers, we designed and piloted the EMDD curriculum in 30 Schools of Specialized Excellence (SoSE) to nurture entrepreneurial thinking in students — helping them identify problems, design solutions, take ownership, and build resilience.



Implementation Snapshot : Curriculum design for 4 units | 7 co-creation workshops with teachers | 6 school observation visits

What we saw:

Teachers reported improved student engagement, higher participation, and stronger problem-solving behaviors. Students demonstrated curiosity, risk-taking, and ownership — indicators of an entrepreneurial mindset taking root.

Looking Ahead: The upcoming phase focuses on-

- Classroom observations & feedback loops
- Redesigning units aligned to IB inquiry-based methodology
- Exemplars and reflection tools for teachers and students

Kshamtalaya's role in this collaboration exemplifies our belief that when teachers co-create and students lead their learning, transformation becomes inevitable.

A SNAPSHOT OF OUR ACHIEVEMENTS: COLLABORATIONS, PARTNERSHIPS, RECOGNITIONS

SYSTEMIC COLLABORATIONS



Contributed to 7 SCF position papers and 3 draft frameworks with RSCERT.



Developed induction training modules for Rajasthan's new government teachers.



Partnered with DBSE (Delhi Board of School Education) to co-develop curriculum.

EXPANDING GEOGRAPHIES



Bihar: MoU with Bihar Education Project Council – transforming 10 schools in Samastipur.



Sirohi, Rajasthan: Cluster Excellence Model in 10 schools of Pindwara block.

RECOGNITION & INFLUENCE



Mahatma Award for Social Good and Impact.

Invited to Aadi Mahotsav, Rajasthan's first tribal festival, as a knowledge partner.

Showcased experiential learning at Milan Mela by Kotda Adivasi Sansthan.

Engaged in Wipro Education Partners Network (150 orgs nationwide).

KNOWLEDGE & NETWORKS



Launched Moodle-based MIS for data management and real-time decision-making.



Collaborated with SEE Learning India, Playquity, Piramal Foundation, Vidya Bhavan Society, and others.

With Deep Gratitude

We extend our heartfelt thanks to everyone who has been part of this journey. To the teachers, children, parents, and fellows who bring joy and meaning to learning every day.

To the community leaders and Sarpanches who walk alongside us with trust and conviction.

To our institutional partners—RSCERT, DIET, Bihar Education Project Council, EdelGive Foundation, Brio Health Global, Emory University, Wipro Foundation—and all our collaborators who strengthen our work with their expertise and commitment.

And to our donors and well-wishers, whose unwavering support and belief in us continue to make everything possible.

Together, you make our mission come alive.

